Pressure Cooker



Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 3 labs

Covers these lab items: Pressure Cooker; Pressure Cooker ISI Certified; Pressure Cookers (Different Sizes)

What it is used for

A pressure cooker cooks food in a sealed vessel using controlled steam pressure to increase cooking temperature and reduce cooking time. Correct filling, vent cleaning, gasket condition, and pressure release are essential to prevent burns and pressure-related accidents.

Main parts

- Cooking body holds the food and cooking liquid.
- Lid closes and seals the cooking vessel.
- Gasket or sealing ring creates the pressure seal.
- Pressure regulator controls operating pressure on compatible models.
- Vent tube or steam outlet allows steam to escape through the regulator.
- Safety valve or pressure-release device provides additional pressure protection.
- Lid-locking mechanism helps prevent opening under pressure.
- Handles allow safe carrying when the cooker is cool or depressurised.

Before you start

1. Only users familiar with the pressure cooker's instructions should operate it.
2. Check the cooker body, lid, handles, gasket, regulator, vent tube, and safety valve for damage or blockage.
3. Confirm that the gasket is correctly fitted and is not cracked, stretched, or hardened.
4. Ensure the vent tube and pressure-release components are clean and unobstructed.
5. Add the required food and cooking liquid without exceeding the manufacturer's maximum fill line.
6. For foods that expand or foam, follow the reduced fill limit stated in the manual.
7. Place the cooker on a stable, suitable heat source and keep the handle clear of flames where applicable.

How to use

1. Place the prepared ingredients and required liquid inside the cooker without exceeding the permitted fill level.
2. Check the sealing ring and lid alignment before closing the cooker.
3. Lock the lid using the manufacturer's specified method.
4. Set the pressure regulator or valve according to the recipe and cooker instructions.
5. Heat the cooker and monitor it until the required pressure is reached.
6. Reduce the heat as instructed to maintain the appropriate operating pressure.

7. Observe the cooker during operation and check for unusual leakage, blocked vents, or abnormal sounds.
8. Turn off the heat when cooking is complete and follow the specified pressure-release method.
9. Wait until pressure has fully released and the pressure indicator confirms it is safe to open.
10. Open the lid away from the face and body to avoid escaping steam.
11. Remove food carefully, clean the cooker after it cools, and inspect components before storage.

⚠ Safety

- Never force the lid open while pressure remains inside the cooker.
- Never block, cover, or tamper with the vent tube, regulator, or safety valve.
- Do not fill above the manufacturer's maximum level or ignore special limits for foaming foods.
- Keep face, hands, and body away from escaping steam and the lid opening.
- Do not use a cooker with a damaged gasket, blocked vent, faulty safety valve, or deformed lid.
- Do not leave the cooker operating unattended when the manufacturer's instructions or cooking conditions require supervision.

Care & storage

- Clean the cooker body, lid, regulator, and vent tube after use according to the manual.
- Inspect the gasket and safety devices regularly and replace worn parts with compatible components.
- Keep the vent and pressure-release passages clear of food residue.
- Dry the cooker completely and store the lid according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Arrange authorised repair or replacement if pressure regulation or locking becomes unreliable.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Overfilling the cooker or using too little cooking liquid.
- Opening the lid before pressure has fully released.
- Using a cooker with a blocked vent tube or damaged gasket.
- Attempting to modify or disable pressure safety devices.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.